

Chip Patina

Your grievance with Grant

Grant pressured you to soften a conservation report showing that one supposedly untouched object had been recently altered. He threatened to replace you with a private conservator if you refused.

Your other secret

You changed the date on a minor treatment record last month to spare the museum an embarrassing insurance dispute. No object was harmed, but the falsification could end your career.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Find out whether Cary has noticed the altered treatment date.
3. Ask Art what he thinks the Star Bowl's modern adhesive means.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Round 1 / Motive

When questioned, read your answer. It is the same whether you are innocent or the murderer.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

My report showed that a supposedly untouched object had been altered recently. Grant wanted that softened. He threatened to replace me with a private conservator. I preserve objects; I am not employed to preserve his version of events.

Your next action

Ask the next seated guest their named Motive question in the question catalog. Note one grievance that might matter. Wait for the host before turning the page.

Round 2 / Opportunity

When questioned, read the answer for your role. Keep the section labels to yourself.

IF INNOCENT

I went into the Donor Salon at 6:43, explaining the condition report. I visited the conservation display, checking the conservation stock, but did not borrow the cabinet key.

IF MURDERER

I went into the Donor Salon at 6:43, explaining the condition report. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the conservation stock stored inside.

After answering, ask the next seated guest their named Opportunity question in the catalog. Wait for the host before turning the page.

Round 3 / Method

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: IF INNOCENT = Card A; IF MURDERER = Card B. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

When questioned, read your answer below, then your selected receipt. Leave the unused card hidden.

IF INNOCENT

I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a display tool after setup. That was what the materials desk issued me.

IF MURDERER

I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a display tool after setup. That was what the materials desk issued me.

Put the read receipt on the Evidence Table. Discuss, then vote privately. The host will distribute FINALE envelopes only after collecting all ballots.